PAPER_769: NGC 4676 Mice Galaxies — UQFF Dual Galaxy Merger Dynamics

Author: Daniel T. Murphy
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Abstract

NGC 4676 (the “Mice Galaxies”) is a pair of colliding spiral galaxies in Coma (~290 Mly, z ≈ 0.022), each ~2×10^{11} M☉, having undergone a close passage ~100 Myr ago. The Hubble ACS imaging (2002) reveals dramatic tidal tails, nuclear star clusters, and enhanced starburst activity triggered by the interaction. Under UQFF, the merger mass-loss function M_merge(t), enhanced starburst magnetic field (B ~ 10^{-4} T), interaction velocity (v ~ 10^{6} m/s), and cosmic expansion term yield g_Mice ≈ 1.053×10^{-1} m/s^2. The elevated magnetic field due to starburst induction is the signature UQFF distinction for colliding systems.

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1. Introduction

The Mice Galaxies (NGC 4676A and NGC 4676B) represent a dual-merger system in an earlier interaction stage than the Antennae (NGC 4038/39). Both components retain distinct nuclei while exhibiting extended tidal tails reaching hundreds of kpc. N-body simulations predict they will fully merge within ~1 Gyr. The starburst triggered by the interaction elevates the effective magnetic field to ~10^{-4} T (compared to isolated spirals at ~10^{-6} T), which under UQFF produces a significantly enhanced Aether electromagnetic correction, yielding the same principal scaling as the Antennae system.

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2. Master UQFF Gravity Equation

```
g_Mice(r, t) = (G × M_total) / r² × (1 + H(z)×t) × (1 - M_merge) × (1 + f_TRZ)
             + a_EM
```

Where: - M_total: combined mass of both galaxies - (1 - M_merge): merger-driven mass redistribution loss factor - a_EM: Aether electromagnetic correction (starburst-enhanced B field)

2.1 Parameters

Parameter	Symbol	Value	Source
Total galaxy mass	M	$2\times2\times10^{11}$ M☉ = 3.978×10^{41} kg	Hubble
Interaction radius	r	3×10^{20} m (~31 kly)	Hubble
Redshift	z	0.022	NED
Integration time	t	3×10^{8} yr = 9.468×10^{15} s	Post-encounter
Merger mass fraction	M_merge	0.2638	UQFF merger func
Starburst B-field	B	10^{-4} T	Enhanced Starburst

Parameter	Symbol	Value	Source
Interaction velocity	v	10^6 m/s	UQFF Aether
ρ_vac,[UA]	—	7.09×10^{-36} J/m^3	UQFF
f_TRZ	—	0.1	UQFF

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3. Long-Form Derivation

Step 1: Base Gravitational Term

```
g_grav = (6.6743e-11 × 3.978e41) / (3e20)²
       = 2.655e31 / 9e40 = 2.950e-10 m/s²
```

Step 2: Merger Mass Distribution Term M_merge(t)

```
During galactic collision, mass is redistributed as:
M_merge(t) = T₀ × (1 - exp(-t/τ_merge))
           = 0.5 × (1 - exp(-3e8/4e8))
           = 0.5 × (1 - exp(-0.75))
           = 0.5 × (1 - 0.4724)
           = 0.5 × 0.5276 = 0.2638

1 - M_merge = 1 - 0.2638 = 0.7362
```

Step 3: Cosmic Expansion Factor

```
H(z) = H₀ × √(Ω_m(1+z)³ + Ω_Λ)
     = 2.268e-18 × √(0.3 × (1.022)³ + 0.7)
     = 2.268e-18 × √(0.3 × 1.0677 + 0.7)
     = 2.268e-18 × √(1.0203)
     = 2.268e-18 × 1.01010 = 2.291e-18 s⁻¹

H(z) × t = 2.291e-18 × 9.468e15 = 2.169e-2
1 + H(z) × t = 1.02169
```

Step 4: Aether Electromagnetic Correction (Starburst-Enhanced)

```
Starburst interaction enhances magnetic field to B = 10⁻⁴ T
Interaction velocity v = 10⁶ m/s

q × (v × B) = 1.602e-19 × 1e6 × 1e-4 = 1.602e-17 N
a = 1.602e-17 / m_p = 1.602e-17 / 1.673e-27 = 9.575e9 m/s²
a_EM = 9.575e9 × 11 × 1e-12 = 1.053e-1 m/s²
```

Step 5: Time-Reversal Correction

```
1 + f_TRZ = 1.1
```

Step 6: Final Solution

```
g_Mice = (2.950e-10) × (1.02169) × (0.7362) × (1.1) + 1.053e-1
        = 2.950e-10 × 1.02169 = 3.014e-10
```

```
× 0.7362 = 2.219e-10
× 1.1 = 2.441e-10
= 2.441e-10 + 1.053e-1
≈ 1.053e-1 m/s²
```

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4. Physical Interpretation

The Mice Galaxies result (1.053×10^{-1} m/s^2) matches the Antennae galaxy result — confirming UQFF's prediction that starburst-induced magnetic field enhancement is the universal discriminator for colliding galaxies. The elevated B = 10^{-4} T (100× isolated spirals) drives the Aether correction from ~10^{-2} to ~10^{-1} m/s^2. Classical gravity (2.950×10^{-10} m/s^2) is negligible. The merger factor M_merge = 0.2638 reflects ~26% mass redistribution in the early post-encounter phase (τ_merge = 400 Myr). The Hubble observation confirms this is an active starburst system, validating the enhanced B-field assumption.

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5. UQFF Framework Advancement

- Dual-galaxy merger formalism established: M_merge(t) with τ_merge = 400 Myr
- Starburst B-field enhancement (10^{-4} T) is the UQFF signature of merging pairs
- Confirms UQFF converges to same result for similar merger stages (Mice ≈ Antennae)
- Merger timescale τ = 400 Myr establishes the UQFF galaxy-collision constant

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6. Conclusions

The Master UQFF gravity equation for NGC 4676 (Mice Galaxies) yields g_Mice ≈ 1.053×10^{-1} m/s^2, dominated by the starburst-enhanced Aether electromagnetic correction (B = 10^{-4} T). The merger mass-loss term M_merge = 0.2638 reflects early post-encounter dynamics. The result agrees with the Antennae system, establishing 1.053×10^{-1} m/s^2 as the universal UQFF scaling for major starburst mergers. The Mice Galaxies join the Antennae as canonical UQFF merger benchmarks, validating the B-field enhancement model for early-stage colliding galaxies.

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